PREMIER LEAGUE 2026/27 · MATCHWEEK 9

Chelsea v Manchester United

Stamford Bridge, London · October 31, 2026 (Saturday) · Kickoff 7:30 AM Central / 12:30 UK

PROJECTED XI — NOT CONFIRMED

NO.	PLAYER / POSITION	FROM	AT CHELSEA	PREVIOUSLY	PLAYING STYLE	KEY STATS
– GK	**Mike Penders** GOALKEEPER	Belgium	Signed 2025; first-team squad from 2026 after a…	Genk; Strasbourg (loan)	Tall, quick off his line and comfortable with the ball at his feet.	2025–26, STRASBOURG (LOAN) 33 Ligue 1 apps, 50 apps all comps
34 RCB	**Josh Acheampong** CENTRE-BACK	England	Academy graduate; first-team regular from 2026	Chelsea academy	Composed young centre-back who reads danger early and is comfortable stepping into midfield with the ball.	—
5 CB	**Maxence Lacroix** CENTRE-BACK	France	July 2026, about £52m ($69m) from Crystal Palace	Crystal Palace; Wolfsburg; Sochaux	Reportedly the fastest centre-back in the Premier League by top speed.	2025–26, CRYSTAL PALACE 35 apps (all starts), 11 clean sheets
6 LCB	**Levi Colwill** LEFT CENTRE-BACK	England	Academy from 2012; first team since 2023 — 4th senior…	Chelsea academy; Huddersfield Town & Brighton (loans)	Left-footed, unflustered, progresses the ball through the left channel rather than sideways around it.	2025–26, CHELSEA — ACL RECOVERY 4 apps
7 RWB	**Pedro Neto** WINGER	Portugal	Since July 2024, about £54m from Wolves	Wolverhampton Wanderers; Lazio; Braga academy	Direct, one-v-one dribbler who attacks the byline and cuts back.	2025–26, CHELSEA 5 goals, 6 assists
25 CM	**Moisés Caicedo** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	Ecuador	Since Aug 2023, £100m plus add-ons — 4th season	Brighton; Beerschot (loan); Independiente del Valle	The engine.	2025–26, CHELSEA 84 tackles, 33 apps
14 CM	**Jordan Henderson** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	England	Summer 2026, from Brentford	Brentford; Ajax; Al-Ettifaq; Liverpool; Sunderland; Coventry…	Veteran organiser and senior voice rather than a ball-carrier — screens in front of the defence, sets the tempo with early sideways and forward…	2025–26, BRENTFORD 34 apps
21 LWB	**Jorrel Hato** LEFT WING-BACK / CENTRE-BACK	Netherlands	Since Aug 2025, £35.5m plus add-ons — 2nd season	Ajax; Sparta Rotterdam academy	Left-footed, positionally mature well beyond his age, and more defender than flying full-back.	2025–26, CHELSEA 22 apps (12 starts)
– AM	**Geovany Quenda** WINGER	Portugal	July 2026, about £40m from Sporting CP — deal pre-agreed…	Sporting CP	Direct right-sided winger who can also play wing-back, quick in transition and comfortable taking defenders on one-v-one.	2025–26, SPORTING CP 6 goals, 32 apps
17 AM	**Morgan Rogers** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	July 2026, £117m ($157m) from Aston Villa — club record…	Aston Villa; Middlesbrough; Manchester City academy; loans…	Powerful, low-slung ball carrier who takes possession on the half-turn and drives straight at defenders, and presses like a midfielder.	2025–26, ASTON VILLA 10 goals, 6 assists
10 ST	**Cole Palmer** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	Since Sept 2023, £40m — 4th season	Manchester City (academy and first team)	Left-footed, drifts inside from the right, arrives late into the box, ice-cold from the penalty spot.	2025–26, CHELSEA 10 goals, 1 assist

Projection only — the official XI is published 60–75 minutes before kickoff. Last updated October 28, 2026. chelsea-fc-2026-27.netlify.app